User Experience Research

- Empathize with users
- Build an empathy map
- Understand user pain points
- Explore personas
- Write user stories
- Identify happy paths and edge cases
- Discover the benefits of user journey maps
- Write problem statements and hypothesis statements
- Consider accessibility

UX research

Focuses on understanding user behaviors, needs, and motivations through observation and feedback

Foundational research

Answers the questions:

- What should we build?
- What are the user problems?
- How can we solve them?

Design research

Answers the question :

- How should we build it?

Post-launch research

Answers the question :

- Did we succeed?

UX researcher qualities

- Empathy: Able to understand someone else's feelings or thoughts in a situation
- Pragmatism: Focused on reaching goals
- Collaboration: Can work with a range of people, personalities, and work styles

Primary research

Research you conduct yourself

Secondary research

Research that uses information someone else has put together

Secondary research

Benefits

- Saves time and money
- Immediately accessible
- Backs up primary research

Secondary research

Drawbacks

- No first-hand user interaction
- No specific user feedback

Quantitative research

Focuses on data that can be gathered by counting or measuring

Qualitative research

Focuses on observations about why and how things happen

Interviews

A research method used to collect in-depth information on people's opinions, thoughts, experiences, and feelings

Interviews

Benefits

- Understand what users think and why
- Ask follow up questions

Drawbacks

- Take time and money
- Small sample size

Surveys

An activity where many people are asked the same questions in order to understand what most people think about a product

Surveys

Benefits

- Larger sample size
- Fast
- Inexpensive

Drawbacks

- No in-depth feedback

Usability study

A technique to evaluate a product by testing it on users

Usability studies

Benefits

- Firsthand user interaction
- Challenge our assumptions
- In-depth feedback

Drawbacks

- Only measure how easy a product is to use
- Expensive
- Difference in lab use versus real life

Bias

Favoring or having prejudice against something based on limited information

Thank you